

# Palliative Care

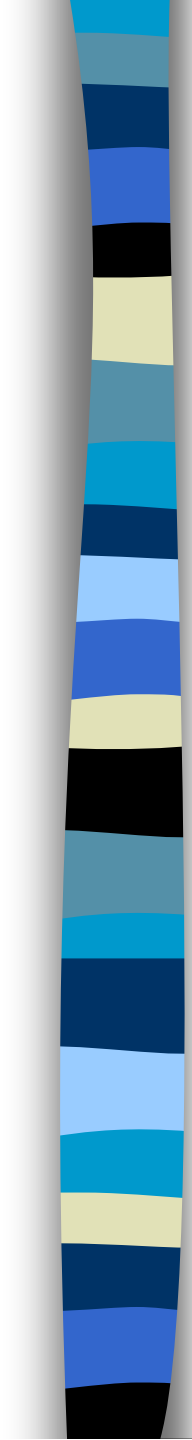


**Prepared by:**

Dr.: Ons Said Mohamed Elzayat  
Assistant professor of community health Nursing

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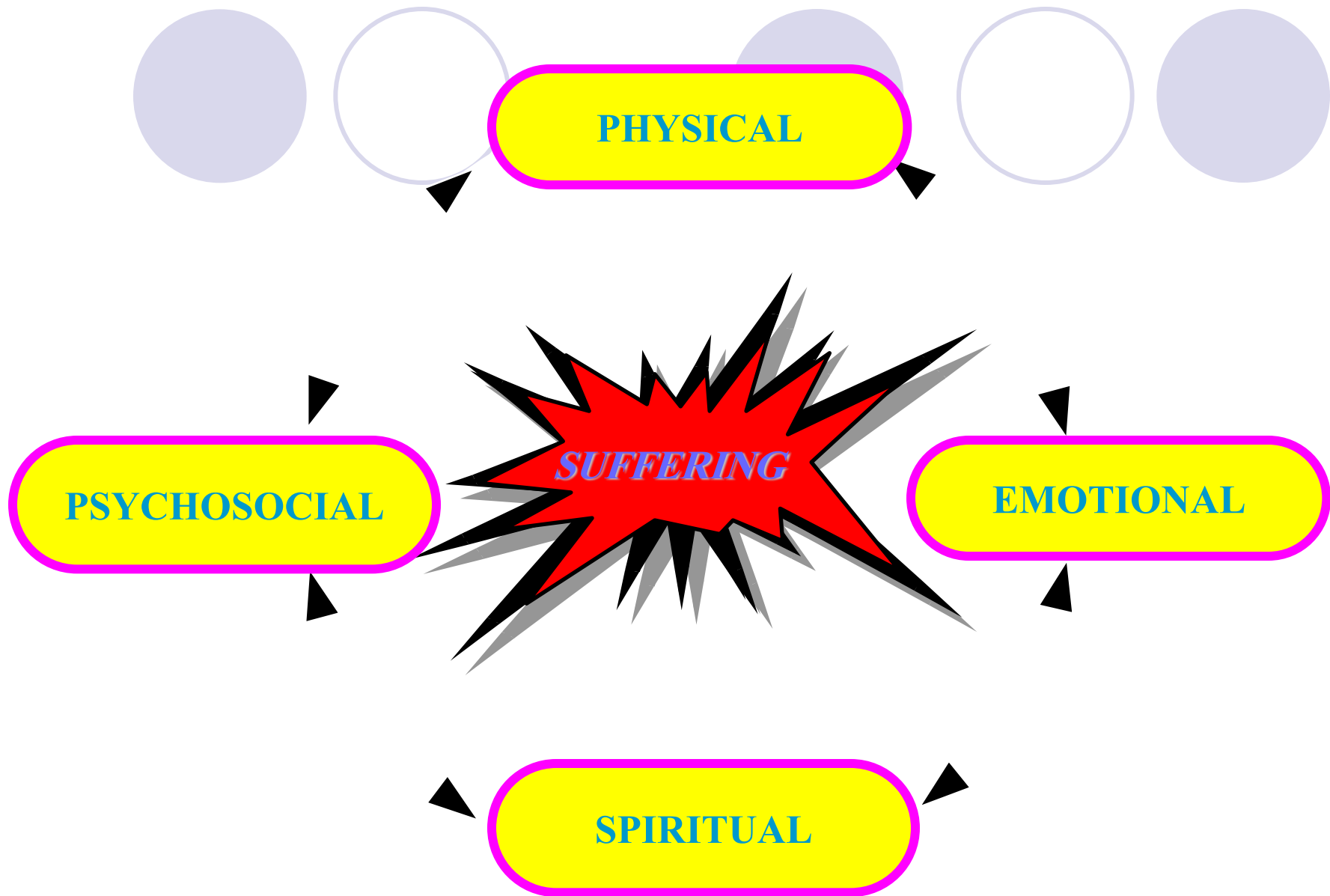


# Introduction

Chronic and non-infectious diseases have been increasing around the world, resulting in an increasing demand for palliative care for patients with life-threatening conditions. Each year, an estimated 40 million people are in need of palliative care, 78% of them live in low- and middle-income countries. Due to this increasing need for palliative care, the World Health Organization proposed that palliative care can be provided in every locally available condition: at home, in hospitals, outpatient clinics and care centers.

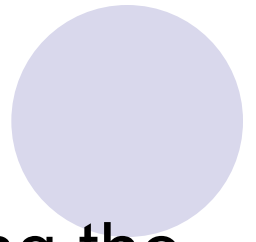
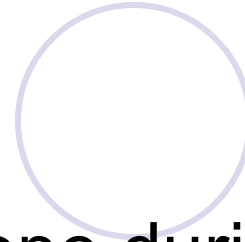
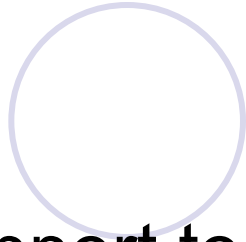
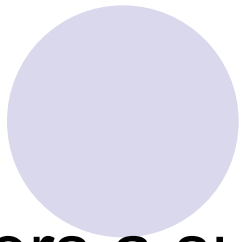
# Definition of Palliative Care (WHO)

Palliative care is an approach that improves the quality of life of patients and their families facing the problem associated with life-threatening illness, through the prevention and relief of suffering by means of early identification, assessment and treatment of pain and other problems, physical, emotional, psychosocial and spiritual.



# Objectives of Palliative care:

- ❖ Provides relief from pain and other distressing symptoms.
- ❖ Affirms life and regards dying as a normal process.
- ❖ Integrates the psychological and spiritual aspects of patient care.
- ❖ Offers a support to help patients live as actively as possible until death.



- ❖ Offers a support to help the family cope during the patients illness and in their own bereavement.
- ❖ Uses a team approach to address the needs of patients and their families, including bereavement counseling.
- ❖ Enhance quality of life and may also positively influence the course of illness.

# Types of diseases requiring Palliative Care

- Cancer( malignancies)
- Cardiac disease such as Congestive Heart Failure (CHF)
- Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD),
- Chronic renal failure,
- Chronic liver disease
- Leukemia
- Neurodegenerative disorders and dementia
- Alzheimer's disease
- Parkinson's disease
- HIV/AIDS

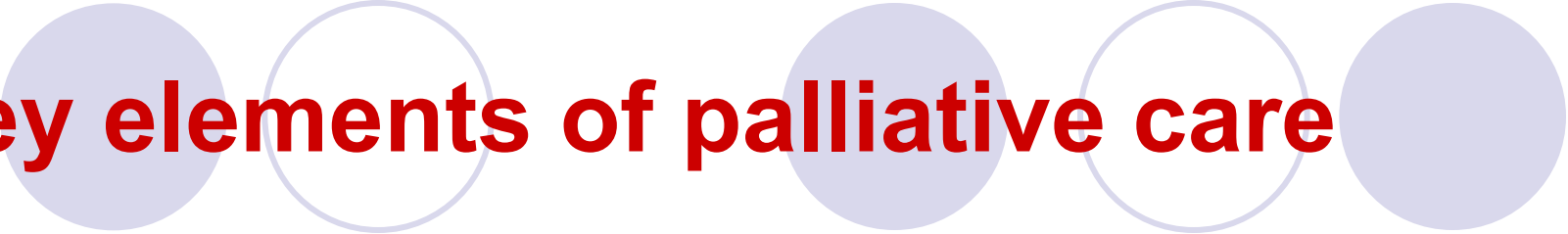




# Domains of Palliative Care

- ❖ Structure and Processes of Care
- ❖ Physical Aspects of Care
- ❖ Psychological Aspects of Care
- ❖ Social Aspects of Care
- ❖ Spiritual Aspects of Care
- ❖ Cultural Aspects of Care
- ❖ Care of Imminently Dying

# Key elements of palliative care



- ❖ Patient population
- ❖ Patient and family centered care
- ❖ Timing of palliative care
- ❖ Comprehensive care
- ❖ Interdisciplinary team
- ❖ Attention to relief of suffering
- ❖ Communication skills
- ❖ Equitable access
- ❖ Quality assessment and performance improvement

# The Palliative Care Team

- ✓ Palliative care physicians
- ✓ Specialists or general practitioners
- ✓ Nurses
- ✓ Nursing assistants or home health aides
- ✓ nutritionists
- ✓ Social workers
- ✓ Spiritual counselors
- ✓ volunteers
- ✓ Chaplains
- ✓ Physical, occupational, and speech therapists



# Where is palliative care provided?

Palliative care can be provided:

- At the home (with support from specially trained staff)
- In a hospital
- In nursing home
- In a hospice center
- Outpatient practice

# **Palliative care at home has many documented benefits. These include the following:**

- Reduced burden of symptoms on the patient and their family
- Increased patient and family compliance to care and treatment
- Improved recovery
- Improved patient and family satisfaction
- Reduced hospital, intensive care and emergency room stays
- Reduced hospitalisations
- Preserving family integrity

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- Enabling the patient to live in their home setting
  - Preventing the social isolation of the individual
  - Providing the highest possible autonomy
  - Allowing the patient to participate in family and social activities and hobbies
  - Reduced risk of infection
  - Allowing a more personal care
  - Reduced stress for the patient and their family
  - Improved quality of life

# Thank You!

Bradford  
Jules

